

CMS 708 — Structured Programming

PGD Computer Science, Rivers State University, Nkpolu-Oroworukwo, Port Harcourt · built from the lecturer's four-module course document, with every C++ listing re-indented so it can actually be read and copied

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WHAT THIS PAPER WILL ASK YOU TO DO

There is **no past paper on file** for CMS 708, so priorities come from the shape of the course document itself. Two facts about it decide everything.

- 1. Every module ends with practice exercises — 23 of them in total.** They are the only assessment-shaped material the lecturer wrote, and they are overwhelmingly of the form "write a program that...". Expect the paper to be dominated by **write-the-code** questions, backed by short theory parts.
- 2. The theory is thin but very quotable** — structured vs unstructured, modularity and readability, by value vs by reference, scope and lifetime, top-down vs bottom-up. Each comes with a real-world analogy in the notes (traffic, wedding, house, car). **Reproduce the analogy** — it is the lecturer's own and it costs one sentence.

Where the marks are: writing correct, complete, compilable C++ · tracing code to predict output · explaining a concept then illustrating it with a short program. **All 23 exercises are solved in Volume II.**

WRITE CODE THE WAY IT IS MARKED

The C++ in the course document lost its indentation when it was converted from Word. **Do not copy that style into your answer booklet.** Every listing in this guide has been re-indented. In the exam, always: **1.** include the headers, **2.** open with `int main() {` and close with `return 0; }`, **3.** indent one level per brace, **4.** end every statement with a semicolon, **5.** add a one-line comment on anything non-obvious. Marks are lost for missing headers and missing `return 0;` far more often than for wrong logic.

1 Definitions to write word-for-word

TERM	DEFINITION
Structured programming	A programming approach that emphasizes the use of clear control structures — sequence, selection and iteration — and modular design instead of arbitrary jumps, so that programs are easier to understand, test and extend. Its philosophy: break a complex problem into smaller, manageable parts and solve each part systematically.
Unstructured programming	An early approach, associated with languages like BASIC and assembly, relying heavily on goto statements and sequential execution. It allowed quick development but produced " spaghetti code ".
Spaghetti code	Programs that are tangled, difficult to read and even harder to maintain , in which the flow of control jumps unpredictably, making debugging and modification a nightmare.
Modularity	Dividing a program into independent units or modules , such as functions or procedures, each performing a specific task and able to be developed, tested and reused independently.
Readability	Ensuring code is understandable not only to the original author but also to others who may maintain or extend it, through meaningful variable names, consistent indentation and clear documentation.
Variable	A named storage location in memory that holds data. It must be declared with a data type, which specifies the kind of values it can store.
Strongly typed	A language in which variables must be declared before use and type mismatches result in errors — C++ is strongly typed.
Operator	A symbol that performs an operation on variables and values. An expression combines variables, constants and operators to produce a result.
Function	A block of code designed to perform a specific task. Functions break complex problems into smaller, manageable parts and must be defined with a return type, a name and parameters (if any); once defined they can be invoked (called) from <code>main()</code> or another function.
Pass by value	A copy of the variable is passed; changes inside the function do not affect the original variable.
Pass by reference	The actual variable is passed, using <code>&</code> ; changes inside the function do affect the original variable.
Scope	Where in a program a variable can be accessed. Local variables are declared inside a function and are accessible only within it; global variables are declared outside all functions and are accessible throughout the program.
Lifetime	How long a variable exists in memory. Local variables exist only while the function runs; global variables exist for the entire program execution.
Recursion	Occurs when a function calls itself to solve a problem. It suits problems that break down into smaller, similar sub-problems, such as factorial or Fibonacci.
Modularisation	The process of breaking a large program into smaller, independent units called modules , each performing a specific task and able to be developed, tested and maintained separately.

TERM	DEFINITION
Top-down design	Starts with the big picture and progressively breaks it into smaller details: define the overall problem, divide into sub-problems, implement each as a module. It emphasizes stepwise refinement .
Bottom-up design	Starts with the smallest building blocks and gradually integrates them into larger systems. It emphasizes reusability .

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Structured vs unstructured programming

CERTAIN QUESTION

BASIS	UNSTRUCTURED	STRUCTURED
Control flow	goto statements and sequential execution; the flow jumps unpredictably	Clear control structures — sequence, selection, iteration
Design	Everything in one block	Modular — divided into functions
Readability	Poor — " spaghetti code "	High — logical flow mirrors human reasoning
Debugging	A nightmare ; errors are hard to isolate	Easy — errors are isolated within modules
Maintenance	Very difficult to modify or extend	Easy to test and extend
Scale	Workable for small tasks; unmanageable for larger projects	Suits large projects and team work
Associated with	Early BASIC, assembly	C, C++, Pascal

The lecturer's analogy — quote it. *"Imagine a traffic system where cars could suddenly teleport to random roads without rules — that's what unstructured programming feels like."* And the closing line of the section: **structured programming replaces chaos with order**, ensuring programs are not only functional but maintainable in the long run.

THE SAME TASK, BOTH WAYS — THE EXAM'S FAVOURITE PAIRING

UNSTRUCTURED – using goto

```
#include <iostream>
using namespace std;

int main() {
    int x = 0;
start:
    cout << "Enter a number (0 to quit): ";
    cin >> x;
    if (x != 0) {
        cout << "You entered: " << x << endl;
        goto start;          // jumps back to start
    }
    cout << "Program ended." << endl;
    return 0;
}
```

STRUCTURED – using a do-while loop

```
#include <iostream>
using namespace std;

int main() {
    int x;
    do {
        cout << "Enter a number (0 to quit): ";
        cin >> x;
        if (x != 0) {
            cout << "You entered: " << x << endl;
        }
    } while (x != 0);
    cout << "Program ended." << endl;
    return 0;
}
```

The sentence that earns the mark: both programs do the same thing, but the **goto** version makes the flow harder to follow, and as the program grows debugging becomes chaotic, while the do-while gives a clear, predictable structure that is easier to read, maintain and extend.

Modularity and readability — the two pillars

Modularity divides a program into independent units, each performing a specific task, developed, tested and reused independently. This **reduces redundancy and enhances collaboration**, since different programmers can work on separate modules without interfering with each other.

Readability ensures code is understandable to others, through **meaningful variable names, consistent indentation and clear documentation**. It avoids unnecessary complexity and follows logical patterns that mirror human reasoning.

Together they make programming **a disciplined activity rather than a chaotic one**, transforming code into a form of communication — **not just between the programmer and the computer, but between programmers themselves**.

Why it matters in practice: teams work on large projects like banking systems, hospital management software or video games. Without modularity the codebase becomes overwhelming.

WITHOUT modularity – everything crammed into main()

```
int main() {
    int a, b;
    cout << "Enter two numbers: ";
    cin >> a >> b;
    cout << "Sum: " << a + b << endl;
    cout << "Difference: " << a - b << endl;
    cout << "Product: " << a * b << endl;
    cout << "Quotient: " << a / b << endl;
    return 0;
} // to reuse these operations we must rewrite them
```

WITH modularity – one function per operation

```
int add(int x, int y) { return x + y; }
int subtract(int x, int y) { return x - y; }
int multiply(int x, int y) { return x * y; }
double divide(int x, int y) { return (double)x / y; }

int main() {
    int a, b;
    cout << "Enter two numbers: ";
    cin >> a >> b;
    cout << "Sum: " << add(a, b) << endl;
    cout << "Difference: " << subtract(a, b) << endl;
    cout << "Product: " << multiply(a, b) << endl;
    cout << "Quotient: " << divide(a, b) << endl;
    return 0;
}
```

Note the cast in `divide: (double)x / y`. Without it, `10 / 3` is integer division and gives **3**, not 3.333. This is a classic exam trap.

Why C++ counts as a structured language

C++ is a **multi-paradigm** language supporting both structured and object-oriented programming, but at its core it provides all the tools needed for structured programming:

- **Control structures** — `if`, `switch`, `for`, `while` and `do-while`, which **enforce logical flow**.
- **Functions** — enabling modular design and code reuse; they can be **parameterised, recursive and organised into libraries**, making them powerful building blocks.
- **Strong typing and data abstraction** — which help programmers manage complexity and avoid errors.

The closing argument to write: although C++ is known for object-oriented features such as classes and inheritance, **its foundation lies in structured programming principles, and mastering them is essential before moving on to more advanced paradigms.**

SYNTAX — THE RULES THAT ARE ALWAYS WORTH A MARK

- Every program begins with a `main()` function, which acts as the **entry point**.
- **Statements end with semicolons.**
- **Blocks are enclosed in curly braces { }.**
- Variables **must be declared with a data type before use** — C++ is strongly typed.
- `#include` brings in a library; `using namespace std;` lets you write `cout` instead of `std::cout`.

THE SIX DATA TYPES IN THE NOTES

TYPE	HOLDS	EXAMPLE LITERAL
int	Integers (whole numbers)	20
float	Single-precision decimals	3.5f
double	Double-precision decimals	45000.0
char	A single character	'A' — single quotes
bool	true / false	true
string	Text — needs <string>	"Ada" — double quotes

```
#include <iostream>
#include <string>
using namespace std;

int main() {
    int age = 20; // integer
    double salary = 45000; // floating-point
    char grade = 'A'; // character
    bool isEmployed = true; // boolean
    string name = "Ada"; // string

    cout << "Name: " << name
          << ", Age: " << age << endl;
    return 0;
}
```

INPUT AND OUTPUT

The `iostream` library provides `cin` for input and `cout` for output. These make programs **dynamic**, letting users supply data in real time instead of hardcoding values.

```
#include <iostream>
using namespace std;

int main() {
    int number;
    cout << "Enter a number: "; // output prompt
    cin >> number; // input from user
    cout << "You entered: " << number << endl;
    return 0;
}
```

Direction of the arrows: `cout <<` sends data **out** to the screen; `cin >>` brings data **in** from the keyboard into the variable. Writing them the wrong way round is the single most common syntax error on this paper. `endl` ends the line.

THE FIVE OPERATOR FAMILIES

FAMILY	OPERATORS
Arithmetic	+ - * / %
Relational	== != < > <= >=
Logical	&& (AND) · (OR) · ! (NOT)
Assignment	= += -= *= /=
Increment / decrement	++ --

Three operator traps. 1. `=` assigns, `==` compares — `if (x = 5)` is always true and is a logic bug, not a syntax error. 2. `%` is the **modulus** — the remainder — and works on integers only; `10 % 3` is 1. It is how you test odd/even and divisibility. 3. Integer division truncates: `10 / 3` is 3. Cast one operand to `double` when you want 3.333.

The payroll example — everything in one program

```
#include <iostream>
#include <string>
using namespace std;

int main() {
    string name;
    double grossSalary, taxRate, netSalary;

    cout << "Enter employee name: ";
    cin >> name;
    cout << "Enter gross salary: ";
    cin >> grossSalary;
    cout << "Enter tax rate (%): ";
    cin >> taxRate;

    netSalary = grossSalary - (grossSalary * taxRate / 100);

    cout << "\nEmployee: " << name << endl;
    cout << "Net Salary: " << netSalary << endl;
    return 0;
}
```

This one program integrates **variables, data types, input/output and operators** — which is exactly what a "write a program that..." question is testing. Learn its shape and you can adapt it to almost any arithmetic scenario the paper sets:

1. Headers and `using namespace std;`
2. Declare every variable you will need, with the right type
3. Prompt, then read, one value at a time
4. Do the calculation in a single clearly-written statement
5. Print the result with a label
6. `return 0;`

Note the formula: `net = gross - (gross × rate / 100)`. Percentage questions are common; the `/ 100` is where marks are lost.

SELECTION — IF AND SWITCH

CONSTRUCT	USE IT WHEN
if	Executing a block if a condition is true
if-else	You need an alternative block when the condition is false
switch	Multiple possible values of one variable must be checked — menus, choices

if-else – grading system

```
int score;
cout << "Enter student score: ";
cin >> score;

if (score >= 70) cout << "Grade: A" << endl;
else if (score >= 60) cout << "Grade: B" << endl;
else if (score >= 50) cout << "Grade: C" << endl;
else cout << "Grade: F" << endl;
```

switch – menu selection

```
int choice;
cout << "Menu:\n1. Add\n2. Subtract\n"
      << "3. Multiply\n4. Divide\n";
cout << "Enter choice: ";
cin >> choice;

switch (choice) {
    case 1: cout << "You chose Addition." << endl; break;
    case 2: cout << "You chose Subtraction." << endl; break;
    case 3: cout << "You chose Multiplication." << endl; break;
    case 4: cout << "You chose Division." << endl; break;
    default: cout << "Invalid choice." << endl;
}
```

Two **switch** rules that are pure marks. 1. Every case needs **break**; — without it execution **falls through** into the next case and every following case runs. 2. **Always write a default**: for invalid input. Also: **switch** works on integers and characters, **not** on ranges or strings — a grading question must use **if-else**, not **switch**.

ITERATION — THE THREE LOOPS

LOOP	USE IT WHEN	TEST HAPPENS
for	The number of iterations is known	Before
while	Repeating as long as a condition remains true , count unknown	Before
do-while	Same as while , but it guarantees at least one execution	After

for – print numbers 1 to 5

```
for (int i = 1; i <= 5; i++) {
    cout << "Number: " << i << endl;
}
```

while – password check

```
string password;
cout << "Enter password: ";
cin >> password;

while (password != "secret") {
    cout << "Wrong password! Try again: ";
    cin >> password;
}
cout << "Access granted!" << endl;
```

do-while – repeated input

```
int num;
do {
    cout << "Enter a positive number (0 to quit): ";
    cin >> num;
    if (num > 0) cout << "You entered: " << num << endl;
} while (num != 0);
```

The **for** header has three parts separated by semicolons: **for** (**initialisation**; **condition**; **update**). Leave out the update and the loop never ends.

The one-line justification examiners want: use **for** when you know how many times; **while** when you do not; **do-while** when the body **must run at least once** — which is why menus and "enter a number until 0" use it.

Nested control structures

Control structures can be **combined or nested** to handle complex logic — a loop may contain an **if**, or an **if** may contain another loop.

Nested for – multiplication table

```
for (int i = 1; i <= 3; i++) {
    for (int j = 1; j <= 3; j++) {
        cout << i << " x " << j
              << " = " << i * j << endl;
    }
    cout << endl; // blank line between tables
}
```

Trace it: the outer loop runs 3 times; for **each** of those the inner loop runs 3 times, so the body executes $3 \times 3 = 9$ times. That multiplication is exactly the reasoning a "how many lines does this print?" question wants.

Operators inside a condition – voting eligibility

```
#include <iostream>
using namespace std;

int main() {
    int age;
    bool hasID;

    cout << "Enter age: ";
    cin >> age;
    cout << "Do you have an ID? (1 for yes, 0 for no): ";
    cin >> hasID;

    if (age >= 18 && hasID) {
        cout << "You are eligible to vote." << endl;
    } else {
        cout << "You are not eligible to vote." << endl;
    }
    return 0;
}
```

Relational operators produce a bool, so they can be combined with **&&**, **||** and **!**. Note that **hasID** is already a **bool**, so **&& hasID** needs no **== true**.

ANATOMY OF A FUNCTION

```
double area(double length, double width) {
//   ↑       ↑       ↑
//   return name parameter list
    return length * width;
}

int main() {
    double l = 5.0, w = 3.0;
    cout << "Area: " << area(l, w) << endl;    // invocation
    return 0;
}
```

A function must be defined with a **return type**, a **name** and **parameters** (if any); once defined it can be **invoked from `main()` or another function**. Here `area()` is **defined once and reused**, which is modularity in one line.

Use **`void`** as the return type when the function returns nothing, and then write no **`return`** value.

SCOPE AND LIFETIME

```
#include <iostream>
using namespace std;

int globalVar = 100;           // global variable

void showLocal() {
    int localVar = 50;         // local variable
    cout << "Local variable: " << localVar << endl;
    cout << "Global variable: " << globalVar << endl;
}

int main() {
    showLocal();
    cout << "Global in main: " << globalVar << endl;
    // cout << localVar;    // ERROR: not accessible here
    return 0;
}
```

Scope = where a variable can be accessed. **Lifetime** = how long it exists in memory. Local variables exist **only while the function runs**; global variables exist **for the entire program execution**. The commented-out line is the exam's favourite illustration — say **why** it fails.

PARAMETER PASSING — THE GUARANTEED COMPARISON

BY VALUE — a copy is passed

```
void incrementByValue(int x) {
    x++;
    cout << "Inside function: " << x << endl;
}

int main() {
    int num = 10;
    incrementByValue(num);
    cout << "Outside function: " << num << endl;
    return 0;
}
```

OUTPUT: Inside function: 11
Outside function: 10 ← original unchanged

BY REFERENCE — the actual variable is passed

```
void incrementByReference(int &x) {    // note the &
    x++;
    cout << "Inside function: " << x << endl;
}

int main() {
    int num = 10;
    incrementByReference(num);
    cout << "Outside function: " << num << endl;
    return 0;
}
```

OUTPUT: Inside function: 11
Outside function: 11 ← original modified

BASIS	BY VALUE	BY REFERENCE
What is passed	A copy	The actual variable
Syntax	<code>int x</code>	<code>int &x</code>
Effect on original	None	Modified
Memory	Extra copy made	No copy
Use when	The function only needs to read the value	The function must change the caller's variable, e.g. a swap

Recursion

```
#include <iostream>
using namespace std;

int factorial(int n) {
    if (n == 0) return 1;           // base case
    else return n * factorial(n - 1); // recursive call
}

int main() {
    int num = 5;
    cout << "Factorial of " << num
        << " is " << factorial(num) << endl;
    return 0;
}
```

Recursion occurs when a function **calls itself**. It suits problems that break into **smaller, similar sub-problems** — factorial, Fibonacci. **Every recursion needs a base case** that stops it; the notes warn that recursion **must be used carefully** to avoid infinite loops or excessive memory usage.

TRACE IT — FACTORIAL(5)

```
factorial(5) = 5 * factorial(4)
factorial(4) = 4 * factorial(3)
factorial(3) = 3 * factorial(2)
factorial(2) = 2 * factorial(1)
factorial(1) = 1 * factorial(0)
factorial(0) = 1                      ← base case, unwinding starts

= 1 * 1 = 1
= 2 * 1 = 2
= 3 * 2 = 6
= 4 * 6 = 24
= 5 * 24 = 120
```

Write the trace out like this in the exam — a "show how the recursion evaluates" question is asking for exactly these two columns: the winding down to the base case and the unwinding back up.

Modularisation is the process of breaking a large program into smaller, independent units called **modules**, each performing a specific task and able to be developed, tested and maintained separately. **This mirrors how we solve problems in everyday life: instead of tackling everything at once, we divide tasks into manageable parts.**

The lecturer's wedding analogy — write it. "Imagine planning a wedding. Instead of one person handling everything, responsibilities are divided into modules: catering, decoration, music, photography and guest management. Each team focuses on its module, and when combined, the wedding runs smoothly."

In programming, modularisation ensures that: code is **reusable** (a function written once can be used in many places) · programs are **easier to debug** (errors are isolated within modules) · teams can **collaborate** (different programmers work on different modules).

TOP-DOWN DESIGN

Starts with the **big picture** and progressively breaks it down. Define the overall problem, divide it into sub-problems, implement each as a module. It emphasizes **stepwise refinement**.

Analogy: building a house — the architect first designs the overall structure (rooms, floors, layout), then each part is broken down into plumbing, wiring, roofing and painting. **Overall design first, then the details.**

```
// High-level function
void manageStudent() {
    cout << "Managing student records..." << endl;
    // Refined later into smaller tasks
    cout << "1. Add student\n"
         << "2. Delete student\n"
         << "3. View student\n";
}

int main() {
    manageStudent();    // start with the big picture
    return 0;
}
```

The broad task "manage student records" is later refined into `addStudent()`, `deleteStudent()` and `viewStudent()`.

BOTTOM-UP DESIGN

Takes the opposite approach: start with the **smallest building blocks** and gradually integrate them into larger systems. Implement reusable components first, then combine them. It emphasizes **reusability**.

Analogy: assembling a car — engineers first design the engine, tyres and seats; once these modules are ready they are integrated into the complete car. **Details first, then the overall system.**

```
// Small building blocks
double add(double a, double b)    { return a + b; }
double multiply(double a, double b) { return a * b; }

// Larger system built from those modules
void calculate() {
    double x = 4, y = 2;
    cout << "Sum: "    << add(x, y)    << endl;
    cout << "Product: " << multiply(x, y) << endl;
}

int main() {
    calculate();    // integrates smaller modules
    return 0;
}
```

ASPECT	TOP-DOWN DESIGN	BOTTOM-UP DESIGN
Starting point	Big picture — the overall problem	Small modules — the building blocks
Focus	Stepwise refinement	Reusability of components
Real-life example	An architect designing a house	An engineer assembling car parts
Programming approach	Define main tasks, then refine	Build small functions, then integrate

The concluding sentence the notes give — do not omit it: both approaches are valuable, and in practice programmers often use a **hybrid approach**, combining top-down planning with bottom-up implementation to balance clarity and reusability.

7 Things you can lose easy marks on

- Omitting `#include <iostream>` or using namespace `std`; . Write them every single time, and `<string>` whenever you use `string` .
- Forgetting `return 0;` at the end of `main()` .
- Writing `cin <<` or `cout >>` . Output goes **out** with `<<` , input comes **in** with `>>` .
- Using `=` where `==` is meant inside an `if` .
- Missing `break;` in a `switch` — every case falls through to the next.
- Integer division: `10 / 3` gives `3`. Cast to `double` when a decimal is wanted.
- A loop with no update statement, so it never terminates.
- A recursive function with **no base case** — infinite recursion and a crash.
- Forgetting the `&` when the question says "pass by reference" — the function then silently changes nothing.
- Using a local variable outside its function and expecting it to compile.
- Confusing `'A'` (char, single quotes) with `"A"` (string, double quotes).
- Writing flat, unindented code. **Readability is an examinable topic on this course** — losing marks for unreadable code in a structured-programming exam is avoidable.

TIMING PLAN FOR A 3-HOUR PAPER

Read everything first and **start with the coding question you can already picture** — code either comes out or it does not, and starting with a solid one banks marks while you are fresh. Budget roughly **30 minutes per question**. For any "write a program" part, spend the first two minutes writing the **skeleton** — headers, `main()` , variable declarations — because that structure scores even if the logic in the middle is imperfect. Then fill in the logic, then **trace it once with a sample input** before moving on: a two-minute trace catches the missing `break;` or the off-by-one that would otherwise cost the whole question. Leave the pure theory parts for last — they are the fastest to write under time pressure.